

# Project Instructions — Stage 6: Data Preprocessing

---

All paths below are inside `project/`.

Today's Project Contribution:

Today you'll complete a piece of your full data project.

This task aligns with the Data Preprocessing stage, where you will:

- Clean, transform, and prepare the dataset for modeling.
- Add to your existing project repo (or update prior files)

By the end of this assignment, your project should include the elements listed below.

## Deliverable Options

- Load and structure the raw data.
- Develop reusable data cleaning/preprocessing functions.
- Store these functions in `src/cleaning.py`.
- Save this script in the `src/` folder to keep code modular and organized.
- Document assumptions made during cleaning and their rationale.
- Include a notebook demonstrating the preprocessing transformations.
- Add documentation in the notebook or a dedicated section in the project README.
- Save the preprocessed dataset.
- Add a cell to `notebooks/project_pipeline.ipynb` that runs what you built this stage, then run the notebook top to bottom to confirm everything you have built so far still works.

## How This Fits Into Your Final Project

Your work today builds toward a complete, end-to-end project.

In your homework, you produced reusable cleaning functions and applied them to a dataset. Now, you will adapt those functions to clean and prepare your actual project dataset.

Before next class:

- Save your files in the appropriate folders (`data/`, `src/`, `notebooks/`)
- Commit and push your changes to your GitHub repo
- Review any assumptions, risks, or notes — these will carry across your stages

By the end of the course, your full project will follow the complete lifecycle.